

Hevajra Tantra, the King of Tantras

Hevajratantrarājanāma · Toh 417 · Derge Kangyur

ཀུན་རྒྱལ་ཐུགས་རྒྱལ་པོ་

The Hevajra Tantra, known in Sanskrit as the Hevajra Tantra Raja and in Tibetan as Kyé Dorjé (ཀུན་རྒྱལ་ཐུགས་རྒྱལ་པོ་), is one of the most celebrated and influential texts in the Vajrayāna Buddhist tradition, belonging to the class of Yoginī or Highest Yoga Tantras. It is a royal tantra — "king of tantras" as its own title declares — centered on the deity Hevajra, a wrathful, enlightened form whose practice encompasses profound teachings on the nature of reality, the nonduality of compassion and emptiness, and the transformation of experience through esoteric ritual and meditation. The text unfolds as a dialogue prompted by the bodhisattva Vajrahṛdaya questioning the Blessed One, who speaks from a state identified as the very essence of the body, speech, and mind of all Tathāgatas. This text is Toh 417 in the Kangyur, preserved within the collection of Tantric scriptures, and its importance is reflected in the extensive commentarial literature it generated across the major schools of Tibetan Buddhism.

In the language of India: Hevajra Tantra Raja Nama. In the language of Tibet: That Which Is Called Hevajra, the King of Tantras.

Homage to Hevajra.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One, the essence of the body, speech, and mind of all Tathāgatas, was dwelling in the bhaga of the Vajra Queen.

Then the Blessed One, the essence of the body, speech, and mind of all Tathāgatas — the supremely secret beyond the secret — declared: "How wondrous! O Vajrahṛdaya (Vajra-Heart), great bodhisattva of great compassion — excellent! Let Vajrasattva, the great bodhisattva, the great samaya-being, and the essence, Hevajra, listen."

Vajrahṛdaya asked:

For what reason is he called Vajrasattva?

In what manner is he the great bodhisattva?

By what is he the samaya-being?

Let the Blessed One speak this to me.

The Blessed One declared:

He is spoken of as "vajra, the indivisible."

The bodhisattva who unifies the three realms of existence —
by this, through the reasoning of wisdom,
he is spoken of as Vajrasattva.

Filled with the taste of great primordial wisdom,
he is to be spoken of as the great bodhisattva.

Because he ever engages in samaya,
he is to be spoken of as the samaya-being.

Vajrahṛdaya asked:

What is the condensed meaning of the name?

Who is Hevajra?

What is conveyed by the syllable He?

And likewise, what does vajra express?

The Blessed One declared:

He is great compassion itself;
vajra is to be expressed as wisdom.

The tantra whose very nature is method and wisdom —
hear this, which I shall explain.

The passionate gaze, the summoning gesture, the great signal,
the many-formed performance of activity, the causing of pride,
the act of driving out, the causing armies to scatter,
the fierce rites of subjugation —

how, in accordance with the yoga-woman's nature,
the arising, the abiding, the cause of action,
the accomplishment of aims, primordial wisdom, consciousness,
and how the deities arise —

the Heruka is the cause for the arising;
first, one is to meditate on the single one.

O Vajrahṛdaya of great compassion,
one is liberated by the very nature of things,
yet one becomes bound by the bondage of things.

Through fully knowing them, one is freed.

Through fully knowing the absence of things,
one who possesses wisdom will come to meditate on things.

Through fully knowing the absence of things,
in this way Heruka is to be meditated upon.

In the body great primordial wisdom abides;
all conceptual thought is perfectly abandoned.
He who pervades all things —
he abides in the body, yet is not born from the body.

Vajrahṛdaya asked: "O Blessed One, how many channels are there in the vajra body?"

The Blessed One declared: The channels are thirty-two. The awakening mind flows through thirty-two, dripping down into the abode of great bliss.

Among these, three channels are primary: the Lalanā, the Rasanā, and the Avadhūtī. The Lalanā abides in the nature of wisdom; the Rasanā abides correctly as method; the Avadhūtī abides in the center, having abandoned apprehended object and apprehending subject. The Lalanā flows as Akṣobhya; the Rasanā likewise flows as blood; what flows as the moon of wisdom is proclaimed to be the Avadhūtī, most widely renowned.

The channels are: Abhinnā, Sūkṣmarūpā, Ramā, Vāmā, Hrasvatī, Kūrmajā, Meditating One, Ruling One, Defective One, Entering One, Māmakī, Night One, Śītalā, Hot One, Lalanā, Avadhūtī, Rasanā, Leaning One, Rejoicing One, Very-Formed One, Universal One, Cause-Giving One, Union-Free One, Lovely One, Accomplished One, Harming One, Good-Minded One, Three-Ring One, Desiring One, Household One, Caṇḍālī, and Māra-Splitting One.

Vajrahṛdaya asked: "O Blessed One, what are the nature of these thirty-two?"

The Blessed One declared:

All three realms, thoroughly transformed,
with apprehended and apprehender utterly abandoned,
or else examined through all methods
as the defining mark of things.

The divisions of the vows are also to be explained. Āli and Kāli are moon and sun, wisdom and skillful means. Dharma, saṃbhogakāya, and nirmāṇakāya are body, speech, and mind. As for E-VAM-MA-YĀ: by the form of E, the goddess is Locana; by the form of VAM, she is spoken of as Māmakī; MA is the goddess Pāṇḍaravāsīnī; by the form of YĀ, she is spoken of as Tārā.

The nirmāṇakāya cakra has sixty-four lotus petals; the dharmacakra has eight petals; the saṃbhogakāya cakra has sixteen petals; and the great bliss cakra has thirty-two petals. What is established according to the successive count of

the cakras: the four moments are the variegated moment, the moment of karmic maturation, the moment of depletion, and the moment free from defining marks. The four noble truths are suffering, its origin, its cessation, and the path. The four suchnesses are the suchness of the self, the suchness of mantra, the suchness of deity, and the suchness of primordial wisdom. The four joys are joy, supreme joy, joy free from joy, and innate joy. The four schools are the Sthaviras, the Sarvāstivādins, the Sammitīyas, and the Mahāsāṃghikas. Moon, sun, Āli, Kāli, sixteen vowel-transmissions, sixty-four syllables, thirty-two hours, and four sessions — thus everything comes in sets of four.

At the navel, the blazing Caṇḍālī burns
the five Tathāgatas,
burns also Locana and the rest,
and, through that burning, from the one who bears the hare — the moon —
Hāṃ drips.

This is the first chapter, the Vajra-lineage chapter.

Now the chapter on mantras is to be explained.

OM A-KĀRO MUKHAṂ SARVA-DHARMĀṆĀṂ ĀDYA-ANUTPANNATVĀT OM ĀḤ
HŪṂ PHAṬ SVĀHĀ. This is the torma mantra for all spirits.

BŪṂ ĀṂ JRIM KHAṂ HŪṂ. This is the offering of the Tathāgatas.

OM DEVA PICU VAJRA HŪṂ HŪṂ HŪṂ PHAṬ SVĀHĀ. This is the heart essence of the heroic vajra. The form of the opening syllable of all mantras is GYI, and at the end the forms SVĀHĀ and HŪṂ PHAṬ are to be inserted within.

OM A KA CA ṬA TA PA YA ŚA SVĀHĀ. This is the mantra for stirring the city.

A Ā I Ū Ū Ṛ Ṛ Ḷ Ḷ E AI O AU AM AḤ. These are the seed syllables of the yoginīs.

OM TRAILOKYA-KṢEPA HŪṂ HŪṂ HŪṂ PHAṬ SVĀHĀ. This is for the two-armed one.

OM JVALA JVALA BHYO HŪṂ HŪṂ HŪṂ PHAṬ SVĀHĀ. This is for the four-armed one.

OM KIṬI KIṬI VAJRA HŪṂ HŪṂ HŪṂ PHAṬ SVĀHĀ. This is for the six-armed one.

OM ĀḤ HŪṂ. This is the mantra for the blessing of body, speech, and mind.

OM RAKṢA RAKṢA HŪṂ HŪṂ HŪṂ PHAṬ SVĀHĀ. This is the mantra for purifying the ground.

OM HŪṢ SVĀHĀ — for arousing.

OM AṢ SVĀHĀ — for bringing under power.

OM KHAṢ SVĀHĀ — for expelling.

OM JRĪṢ SVĀHĀ — for causing enmity.

OM BUṢ SVĀHĀ — for fierce rites.

OM HŪṢ SVĀHĀ — for summoning.

OM GHUḢ SVĀHĀ — for slaying.

OM KURU KULLE HRĪḢ SVĀHĀ. This is the mantra of Kurukullā.

With the form of ĀḢ PHŪ, make an image of Amitābha, pour over it the five nectars, worship it with black flowers, anoint it with the semen that tames nāgas, anoint the head with elephant wine, place the skull-cup face-to-face, and fill it with the milk of a black cow.

Bind it with a thread spun by a dark young woman, and set the image, with Ananta pressed beneath it, in a pond on the windward side. Beside that, erect the maṇḍala. The black powder-color is made from charnel-ground charcoal; the white powder-color from the ash of a man's bones; the yellow powder-color from the juice of a red-flesh corpse; the red powder-color from the teeth of charnel-ground swine; and the green powder-color from the leaves of a thief and the sand of a man's bones. With these powder-colors the maṇḍala is erected. Lines are drawn with charnel-ground thread, and the maṇḍala is made three cubits in size. In its center, draw Kye Vajra — who presses down Ananta — with eight faces, four feet, adorned with sixteen arms, twenty-four eyes open, and terrifying even the terrifying.

Then the master, with a mind of inward ferocity, recites the mantra in a solitary place:

OM GHURU GHURU GHUṬU GHUṬU MA SA MA SA GHAṬA GHAṬA GHOṬAYA GHOṬAYA ANANTAKṢOBHAKARĀYE NĀGĀDHIPATAYE HE HE RURU KAṢ SAPTA PĀTĀLAGATĀ NĀGĀ ĀKARṢAYA VARṢAYA GARJAYA TARJAYA PHUḢ PHUḢ PHUḢ PHUḢ PHUḢ PHUḢ HŪṢ HŪṢ HŪṢ PHAṬ SVĀHĀ.

If rain does not fall, at that time recite this mantra in reverse, and rain will fall. If still it does not fall, his head will split apart like the pod of an arjaka plant. This is the rite called Causing Rain to Fall.

For dispersing clouds: sitting close to a charnel-ground shroud, recite the mantra and disperse:

OM ĀRYAŚMAŚĀNAPRIYĀYA HŪṢ HŪṢ HŪṢ PHAṬ SVĀHĀ.

This is the rite for dispersing clouds.

Now the accomplishment of the khaṭikā is explained, for the purpose of destroying the forces of the enemy. Mix khaṭikā with the five nectars and kuṭāracchani, form them into a pill, and recite the mantra:

OM VAJRAKARTTARI HE VAJRĀYA HŪṢ HŪṢ HŪṢ PHAṬ SVĀHĀ.

For the sake of accomplishment, recite ten million times, having first performed the preliminary approach of one hundred thousand recitations. Having accomplished it, wrap the pill around the neck of a pouring vessel, spin it around, and snap it — and all enemies will be left headless. This is the rite of the vajra chopper.

For one who wishes to cause the gods to burst, accomplish a bindu by accomplishing the seed of Brahmā in a vessel, mix it with kuṭāracchani, and when the sun is seized by Rāhu, bind it together with Akṣobhya, then make it into a representation of the enemy and press it down with the foot while reciting the mantra:

OM VAJRAKUṬHĀRA PĀṬAYA PĀṬAYA HŪṢ HŪṢ HŪṢ PHAṬ SVĀHĀ.

Recite ten million times, make the bindu, and whoever it is prostrated before will burst. This is the rite for causing gods to burst.

For one who wishes to cause torment by burning: write the enemy's name on a leaf of the arka plant with poison, long-pepper juice, and the sap of citraka, then burn it in a blaze of rice-husk fire and recite the mantra ten thousand times:

OM HE VAJRA JVĀRA JVĀRA ŚATŪṢ BHRŪṢ HŪṢ HŪṢ HŪṢ PHAṬ SVĀHĀ.

This is the burning rite. It is accomplished by ten thousand recitations.

For one who wishes to cause someone to vomit beer: visualize the syllable YAM at the navel of the subject, then meditate that from it arising in the form of MAM, the beer fills the belly, and look upon them intending that they vomit — and they will vomit the beer.

For one who wishes to bring a thoroughly intoxicated woman under one's power: go beneath an aśoka tree, at one of the eight aśoka trees, dress in red

garments, eat the fruit that induces intoxication, make a bindu with the juice of kākamācīkā, and recite the mantra:

OM AMUKĪ ME HRĪḤ VAŚĪ BHAVATU SVĀHĀ.

She will come within ten thousand recitations.

For one who wishes to bring the moon and the sun under power: make images of the moon and the sun from transformed rice stalks, immerse them in vajra water, and recite the mantra:

OM VAJRA ARKA MĀ CALA MĀ CALA TIṢṬHA TIṢṬHA HE VAJRĀYA HŪṢ HŪṢ HŪṢ PHAṬ SVĀHĀ.

Reciting seventy million times, the sun and moon will stand perfectly still, and day and night will become indistinguishable. This is the rite called Seizing the Moon and the Sun.

With the mantra OM NAGRĀ NAGRĀ, in order to accomplish one's aim at an inauspicious time, one recites it one hundred and eight times over the eyes of a young woman, then makes offering with the fivefold offering of flowers and the rest, and causes auspicious words to descend.

On the morning of the fourteenth or the eighth, one sets out a vase and the like, and recites this same mantra one hundred and eight times over sesame oil and the juice of alakta. Then, anointing the mantra-practitioner's right thumb with the consecrated alakta juice, and pouring sesame oil as well, one shows it to a young woman and says: "Who has taken my substance?" She then speaks, saying: "Such-and-such a one has taken it." And: "It is Vajra Star."

If one says BEṬUYĀ BEṬUYĀ, an elephant will flee.

If one says MAMMĀ MAMMĀ, a tiger will flee.

If one says TELLIYĀ TELLIYĀ, a rhinoceros will flee.

If one says ILI MILI PHU PHU, a snake will flee.

If one extends the hand in the gesture that tames the Wealth-Protector, a dog will flee.

Arousing from meditative absorption those who practice the yoga of Vajradevī, the White One, the Water Goddess, the Vajra Ḍākinī, Nairātmyā, the Earth-Wandering Goddess, and the Sky-Wandering Goddess, and so forth — these things are done by one who holds the discipline.

This is the second chapter, the chapter on mantras.

Now the chapter on the deity will be explained.

First, one meditates on loving-kindness.
Second, one meditates in full on compassion.
Third, one meditates on joy.
And at the culmination of all, equanimity.

Again, the awakening of emptiness is first.
In the second, one gathers the seed.
In the third, one completes the form.
In the fourth, one places the syllables.

On the day before, having first fully visualized the sun disc, on that day there arises from HŪṂ the manifold vajra. With that very vajra, one visualizes in full the enclosure and the bound tent.

Having first meditated on the skull-cup, one speaks of it as identical in nature with the dharmadhātu. Abiding above that, the yogin meditates on Heruka himself.

In one's own heart one visualizes the moon, and from that arises the sun maṇḍala. Within that is the form of HŪṂ, possessed of the nature of skillful means and wisdom. From HŪṂ arises a vajra, black in color, exceedingly terrifying, abiding in the center of the vajra's navel. Again one meditates on the suchness of HŪṂ.

Having looked upon the form of HŪṂ as transformed, one meditates on the nature of aversion. The vajra-born, the Great Black One, is of a hue like the blue water-born lotus, or else blue with the color of the sun. With faith, one visualizes this with certainty.

Looking up to the lord in the sky, the vajra-born, Great Compassion, is served by the eight goddesses who hold all ornaments:

The White One holds the deer-sign.

The vessel of victory over the thieving māra is the zombie goddess, the one with dangling arms.

Ghasmarī holds the medicine.

Pukkasī holds the vajra-hand.

Likewise, the Mountain-Hermit holds a corpse.

The Caṇḍālī strikes the small drum.

By these is the chief one worshipped.

With great attachment, overcome by desire, the handmaid embraces the body. The vowel row — the moon; the consonant row — the sun. The seed

enters inward and is transformed. That very suchness is called sattva, of the nature of supreme joy.

One sends forth emanations in the likeness of one's own body, pervading the maṇḍala of the sky, then gathers them in and draws them into the heart. At that point the yogin becomes the very nature of aversion, of a hue matching blue and the sun, with eyes like red bandhu, with golden hair coiling upward, adorned with the five mudrās: the wheel, the earring, the jewel, the bracelet, and the girdle. The five pure buddhas are renowned as these mudrās.

With sixty-two wrathful eyes in the manner of the year, on the left a vajra skull-cup, and from the left also a khaṭvāṅga, on the right a black vajra, as the master of the utterance of the syllable HŪṂ — surrounded completely by the eight yoginīs, the Protector sports in the charnel ground.

By this reasoning called "the breath of life," the charnel ground is explicitly named. The four hands are the pure, complete victory over the four māras. The forms and body-colors described above arise from HŪṂ. In the first left hand is a freshly born skull-cup filled with the blood of gods and asuras. Similarly, the right hand holds a vajra. The remaining hands embrace the wisdom consort. The Wisdom Vajra Sow is the embodied form of the Blessed One.

Six hands. Three faces. The left face is red. The right face is like moon and sun — the first being blue. Naked, bearing the body-color and form described above. The hands are the pure six perfections. In the first left hand a three-pointed implement; in the first right hand a vajra; in the second left hand a bell; in the second right hand a curved knife; the remaining hands embrace the Vajra Chain in meditative absorption. The Blessed One is the wisdom just as it is. In the right and left hands the curved knife and skull-cup press down upon the corpse that embodies the three realms. This concludes the third chapter, the Chapter on the Deity.

Next, the chapter on empowerment of the deity shall be taught. Contemplate the seed-syllable in your own heart. From the seed-syllable, rays of black light in the form of an iron hook are sent forth. By means of these, invite all buddhas dwelling in the three realms, then make perfect offerings through the eight mother-goddesses, and make supplication. With the mantra Oṃ abhiṣiñcatu māṃ sarva tathāgata — those buddhas, taking the form of Heruka, shall confer empowerment by means of a vase filled with the five nectars that are the very essence of the five Tathāgatas. At the moment of

empowerment, a rain of flowers shall fall. The sound of drums shall arise. A rain of saffron shall fall. The vajra ladies of form and the rest shall make offerings. The vajra-song ladies — the Locana and the rest — shall receive them. Upon receiving the empowerment, one becomes the lord of one's own family at the crown of the head. This constitutes the complete Heruka. Having cultivated the meditation empowered in three sessions and then risen, one establishes it as the deity-form. This concludes the fourth chapter, the Chapter on Empowerment.

Next, the chapter on suchness shall be taught.

In essential nature, there is no form, and no one who sees.

No sound, and no one who hears.

No odor, and no one who smells.

No taste, and no one who tastes.

No tangible object, and no one who touches.

No mind, and nothing arisen from mind.

The mother who generates and the very sister —
the yogin who knows reality constantly venerates them.

The dancing lady, the dyer lady, the vajra lady,
the caṇḍāla woman, and likewise the brahmin woman —
through the rite of method and wisdom,
one who knows suchness constantly venerates them.

Just as one strives earnestly in service without becoming separated,
so one must rely with utmost effort.

The secret emanation, the thief, the earth-walker, and fire
cause suffering.

What is called the mudrā of the five families
is to be explained as the cause of liberation.

By this vajra it is sealed;

therefore it is to be spoken of as the mudrā.

Vajra, Lotus, and likewise Karma,

Tathāgata and Jewel —

great compassion, the supreme —

these families are stated to be fivefold.

The vajra mudrā is the caṇḍāla woman;

likewise the lotus is the dancing lady;

karma is most fittingly explained as the dyer;

the Tathāgata's is the brahmin woman;
and the Jewel is to be known as the caṇḍāla woman.
So the five mudrās are definitively determined.
These are the Tathāgata families.
In brief they are to be stated thus.

The glorious one goes as suchness
and likewise returns again as suchness.
By this reasoning of wisdom,
"Tathāgata" is to be spoken.

The families are spoken of as six in their aspects,
and in brief as five.
Through the distinctions of body, speech, and mind,
they become three externally.
The families of the five aggregates — their intrinsic nature —
and the elements, the gods,
by this enumeration —
— are to be explicitly proclaimed as "families."

There is no meditator and there is nothing meditated upon.
There is no deity and no mantra either.
From the nature that is beyond all utterance,
mantra and deity truly abide.

Vairocana, Akṣobhya, Amoghasiddhi,
Ratnasambhava, the bodhisattva hero,
Brahmā, Viṣṇu, the Peaceful One —
all these are proclaimed as buddhas, that very thing.
Brahmā, being free of obscuration, is buddhahood itself.
Because he pervades all that enters, he is to be called Viṣṇu.
Being always peaceful through virtue, that is the Peaceful One.
Abiding as the essential nature of all and everything,
by the supreme bliss of the holy, that is suchness itself —
because he realizes bliss, he is fully awakened.
Because he arises from the body itself,
he is to be explicitly called "deity" (deva).

This buddha possesses the bhaga,
and so he is to be called Bhagavān, the Blessed One.

The bhaga is spoken of in six aspects:
sovereignty and all such qualities,
or māras such as the afflictions —
because he has overcome them, he is called Bhagavān, the Blessed One.

Because she gives birth to migrating beings,
wisdom is to be called "Mother."

Because she reveals what is fortunate,
wisdom is to be called "Sister."

She is also to be called Cook, Daughter, and Dancer.

Because she nourishes all sentient beings,
she is likewise called "Cook."

Because wisdom dispenses qualities,
she is to be called "Daughter."

Because great compassion is her movement,
wisdom is to be called "Dancer."

Because the Blessed One does not touch her,
she is therefore to be called "Servant-woman."

Having well examined the vowels and consonants,
recitation of speech is correctly explained.

The footprint is precisely the maṇḍala itself,
and because it is so, it is to be called "maṇḍala."

The movement of the hands is the mudrā,
and likewise the interlacing of the fingers.

Because the mind's consciousness in meditative concentration
whatever is contemplated, that is dhyāna.

Just as one obtains bliss from a father,
that bliss is to be consumed by oneself.

The bliss by which this death is undergone —
that bliss is called meditative concentration.

This is the fifth chapter, the chapter on suchness.

Then yet more is to be excellently explained:
the conduct that is the supreme perfection,
by which one arrives at the ultimate siddhi —
through the mastery of siddhis by the Hevajra vajra.

The practitioner takes up the ornaments:
earrings placed upon the ears,
a wheel held upon the crown of the head,
two bracelets upon the wrists,
a belt likewise at the waist,
and anklets at the feet.

On the wrists are armlets,
a bone garland at the throat.
The garment is a tiger skin.
The food is half of the five ambrosias.

The hero born of the Heruka union
abides in five colors,
endowed with equality with the five families.
The family is to be contemplated as single —
because distinction cannot be indicated
through the plurality of colors.

At the root of a lone tree, or in a charnel ground,
in the house of Māmakī, or at night,
or in a solitary place, or at the forest's edge —
meditation there is said to be excellent.

When a little warmth is obtained,
if one wishes to perform the conduct,
if one has the wish to accomplish it,
then this conduct itself is to be practiced.

A woman most well-formed, with wide eyes,
self-empowered and full of compassion —
take this vajra-daughter
and understand that the conduct is to be performed.

If a partner of the Vajra family is not available,
one acts with the family of the deity of one's own choosing.
Or if a woman of another family arises,
she is to be taken up by planting in her the seed of awakening
and by purifying her.

If she sings a song with joy,
she is then endowed with the supreme vajra.
If joy arises,

one dances for the cause of liberation —
then dance with the vajra feet,
performed by the yogin settled in equipoise.

The body of the wheel is Akṣobhya.
The essential nature of the earrings is Amitābha.
The neck garland is Ratnasambhava.
The bracelets are spoken of as Vairocana.
Amoghasiddhi abides in the belt.
The khaṭvāṅga staff in its form is wisdom.
In the form of skillful means, it is the ḍamaru drum.
The yogin, whose aversion is purified —
the song abides as purified mantra,
the dance is precisely what is meditated upon.
Therefore song and dance
the yogin performs always, always.

The medicine is to be consumed entirely.
The water is to be drunk constantly.
One is not overcome by the frost of old age,
and one is always preserved.

A crown is made from the hair of a thief,
and upon it the syllable HŪṂ is to be applied.
The skulls of the five buddhas
are held by the yogin in practice.
A crown measured to five fingers' breadth
is thus worn upon the head.

From the intrinsic nature of skillful means and wisdom,
the hair cord wound twice around the waist —
ash and hair are held as an offering,
worn in the conduct of the yogin.

The sound of the kaṅkāla bell is recitation.
The khaṭvāṅga staff is meditated upon as wisdom itself.
Through the union of vajra and skull,
these become recitation and meditation.

Craving, delusion, fear, and wrath —
abandon entirely the fruit of shame.

Oneself having abandoned sleep,
act without hesitation.

Having given the gift of one's body,
thereafter one enacts conduct authentically.
Since one examines what is fortunate and what is not,
for that reason one should not give generosity selectively.

Likewise with food and drink:
eat whatever is obtained.
Because of the conceptual thought of pleasant and unpleasant,
do not be merely attached.

What is edible and what is not, in conduct,
likewise what is drinkable and what is not,
what is traveled and what is not — for the mantra practitioner,
these should not become conceptual discrimination.

Whatever disciple has obtained accomplishment (siddhi),
who is the illuminator of true wisdom —
because this is the cause of abandoning the Unrelenting Hell,
one who has attained realization pays homage to the guru with prostration.

Freed from training and from empowerment,
likewise freed from the fruit of shame,
the yogin examines with great compassion
the intrinsic nature of all things.

Gone beyond fire-offering, gift-offering, and asceticism,
having abandoned mantra and meditative concentration,
freed from samaya vow and restraint —
the one endowed with yoga enacts conduct.

Even if before one stands an asura
like Śakra (Indra, king of the gods),
one should not be afraid of him,
but roam in the form of a lion.

For the sake of all sentient beings,
one should always drink with compassion.
The yogin delights in drinking — the yogin
is not intoxicated by another's drink.

This is the sixth chapter: the chapter on conduct.

Now the chapter on signs (Skt. cchoma) is to be explained.

With respect to one's brother and sister,
one should know without hesitation.

One who shows a single finger
shows that one arrives with excellence.

From the gesture of clasping the left thumb,
recognize it as the mudrā of illness.

One who shows the ring finger —
offer to that person the little finger.

One who shows the middle finger —
offer to that person the index finger.

One who shows the ring finger —
reveal to that person one's throat.

One who shows cloth —
reveal to that person the three-pronged implement.

One who shows the breast —
reveal to that person the boundary.

One who shows the teeth —
reveal to that person the mouth.

One who shows a frown —
speak of loosening the hair knot.

One who shows the forehead —
reveal to that person the back.

One who shows the sole of the foot —
playfully engage with the belly.

Mudrā is answered by mudrā;
one separates by means of samaya.

Then the yoginī spoke:

"O, great compassion, child!

If one shows a rosary with the hand,
it is said to mean 'come and assemble.'

If the rosary is displayed with intention,
it is fine conduct resolved upon samaya.

To that one is called 'outer';
abiding in the domain of the good —

whatever the yoginī has said of assembling with such a one,
do all of it accordingly."

"O Blessed One, where is the place of assembly?"

The Blessed One declared:

"The place and the nearby place,
the field and the nearby field,
the charnel ground and the nearby charnel ground,
and likewise the assembly and the nearby assembly —"

the tavern and the nearby tavern,
the charnel ground and the nearby charnel ground —
these are the twelve grounds,
and he who is the lord of the ten grounds is the Protector himself.
These are not to be spoken of to others.

"O Blessed One, what are the places and so forth?"

The Blessed One declared:

"The place is called Jālandhara;
likewise Oḍḍiyāna;
the place is Kolāla Mountain;
likewise Kāmarūpa;
the nearby place is spoken of as Mālavā;
and Sindhunagara.

The field is declared as Mummunī;
the field is the breast of the Maker.

Devīkoṭi likewise is a field;
the field is the breast of iron.

The nearby field is called Gulāta;
likewise Arbuda,
the snowy mountain of the supreme gift of the syllable ba —
the nearby field in brief.

Chandoharī and Kela,
born in the midst of the salt ocean,
Lambākā and Kāñcī,
and likewise Saurāṣṭra —
the nearby chandoka is Kaliṅga,
the island endowed with gold,
and Koṅkaṇa also is a nearby chandoka —

this is to be stated in brief.

The tavern city, and again

the tavern dwelling at the edge of the village —

Cāritra and Kośala,

Vindhyā, and the city of the young —

Vajrāsana, great compassion:

the nearby tavern is what is nearby.

The charnel ground is the noble Saṅgha;

the charnel ground is the shore of the ocean.

The grove, the garden, the bank of the pond —

these are to be called the nearby charnel ground.

For the sake of all sentient beings,

O Vajra of the yoginī tantra,

the proper assembly of yoginīs

is also to be declared even in the daytime.

"O Blessed One, what is the day?"

The Blessed One declared:

"The fourteenth of the lunar fortnight for hungry ghosts,

and likewise the eighth,

the day of the banner of victory and the sharp weapon —

one should partake of these seven times.

By arousing compassion with great effort,

the killing is what is declared.

Without compassion it is not accomplished;

therefore one must arouse compassion.

All harmful forces are to be suppressed

by the chief of the rite and blocked.

This is how one should regard the matter.

By day one should examine the Blessed One who is Vajra-holder;

by night one should examine with wisdom.

There is not the slightest thing that must not be done.

There is nothing that one must always not eat.

There is nothing here that must not be contemplated.

There is nothing at all that is good or bad to say.

As one is oneself, so are others.

Likewise, I am the supreme self.

Such is the yogin who thinks in this way:
partaking of food, drink, and so forth,
however many limbs are put to use,
words thoroughly expanded —
abiding in the seat of glorious Heruka,
so many are the mantras and mudrās.
Śrī is nondual gnosis;
he is emptiness of cause and so forth;
ru is freedom from aggregates;
ka is abiding nowhere at all.

Through the practice of the vajra-skull union,
with whatever persons there may be,
the flesh is to be eaten by the wise —
the being of each such person comes under one's power.

This is the seventh chapter, on signs and the determination of places.

Next, the cakra of the yoginī is to be explained.

In the space of the sky, meditate upon the bhaga.
In the center, contemplate it vividly.
The cakra, in accordance with what is fitting, first —
however the deities arise.
The cakra of earth and water is blue;
in accordance with what is fitting, one of lightning-eating;
and by the deities, with the great wind,
however the tortoise arises.
The cakra arisen from the dharmodaya,
two pulses without defect —
from the sesame seed a single one arises;
what comes after is spoken of with three corners.
In its center, the seat of the fifteen dead —
contemplate its own nature fully.
Above that is the moon;
above the moon is the seed syllable.
Subdued from without by the Victor over māra,
from the union of the two arises great bliss.
The āli abides in the form of the moon;

the kālī illuminates in its own form.

From the union of moon and sun
the white and the rest become renowned.

The moon possesses mirror-like wisdom;
the seventh of sevens possesses equanimity.

The seed syllable and hand-emblem of one's own deity
are to be distinguished and declared individually.

All becoming one is the very essence of thoroughness —
completion is the pure dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena.

Through the ritual procedures taught by the learned,
one meditates on the five aspects.

Through the equal union of āli and kālī,
the seat of Vajrasattva itself —
the mound arising from the syllables:
the form of hūṃ and phaṭ is not to be desired there.

Meditate fully on the lord of the maṇḍala
arisen from the reflected image of the hero.

The hand-emblems, faces, and so forth are as described above.

The moon, the light of crystal and jewel,
from the practice of skillful means and wisdom in union —
thus is everything complete.

By the division of moon and sun,
āli is wisdom, kālī is skillful means.
From these, the white and the rest
are distinct through their distinction of color.

Now as for the inner pulses:
the five yoginīs reside therein.

Through the intrinsic nature of the five aggregates,
the yogin endowed with awareness should always meditate.

At the sense faculty: vajra, Yamāntaka in white;
the water lord, the yoginī of water;
the body fierce one, the vajra ḍākinī;
at the center, the selfless yoginī.

As for the outer pulses:
the white one, the thieving one, the zombie;
Ghasmarī and Pukkasī;

the forest-dwelling woman and the caṇḍālī;
the eighth is to be named Ḍombiṇī;
the one endowed below and the one endowed above;
the sky-farer and the earth-farer are named.
Through the nature of existence and peace,
great compassion dwells in these.

All the goddesses are dark of color,
adorned with the five great mighty mudrās.
Their single faces and eyes are red;
their hands are filled with hooked knives and skulls.
Wheels, earrings, and neck ornaments,
and on their arms, bracelets and hip-girdles.
Through the purity of the five buddhas,
these five are pure mudrās.

Just as the selfless yoginī,
so all are explained in this way.
One hand is busy with the skull;
the right hand holds the hooked knife;
the left hand holds the khaṭvāṅga staff.
Wrapped all around in a tiger skin,
she rides on a corpse and blazes with splendor.
Both hands raised, with a yellow diadem on her head,
pride and the other six faults —
to sever these, the hooked knife abides.
The blood of the four aspects of the māras —
thought of what is real and what is unreal —
in the lotus-skull cup upon the head,
is to be drunk for the sake of attainment.
The khaṭvāṅga, in the aspect of emptiness,
through skillful means examines the taste.
By meditating on the cakra in this way,
attainment will be swiftly obtained.

First, meditate fully on the black one;
second, meditate fully on the red one;
third, meditate on the yellow one;
fourth, likewise on the green.

Fifth is the one with a blue body;
sixth is the one with a white body.
The yogin meditating on these six branches —
even to the end, beyond joy, it is likewise so.

The generation stage itself
and the completion stage itself —
abiding in the equality of both stages,
the Vajra-holder expounds the Dharma.
The aspect of the generation stage is explained:
the element of space in the lotus —
the bhaga is spoken of as wisdom.

Meditation is named meditative absorption.
The bliss of that is spoken of as the cakra.
What has gone before is the melting itself.
In due sequence, self-awareness —
the deity called bodhicitta:
just as it arises, it is the fluid.

The co-emergent has two aspects:
for the moment, the consort is wisdom,
and the male is declared to be skillful means.
From the division of conventional and ultimate,
thereafter its two aspects:
for the moment, two aspects of the male —
its fluid is also bliss itself.

Just as the male in relation to wisdom,
its fluid there too is bliss itself.
For that very reason it is joy itself.
Through the fourfold thorough distinction —

From the side of the non-arising sequence,
the four co-emergent joys are as follows.

The first joy is the hero himself.

Supreme joy is the yoginī.

The joy of great bliss is known from everything —
from the method of that bliss, all is known.

The bliss of joy is something moderate;
supreme joy surpasses it.

Joy free from joy is freedom from attachment.
The remaining one is co-emergent joy itself.

The first is the desire for contact.

The second is the desire for bliss itself.

The third is the dissolution of attachment.

Therefore the fourth is to be cultivated.

Supreme joy is said to be existence.

From joy free from joy comes nirvāṇa.

The Middle Way is mere joy —

and by this, co-emergence is abandoned.

There is no attachment and no freedom from attachment;
it cannot be apprehended as the Middle Way.

In this there is no skillful means and no wisdom.

True reality itself appears.

Co-emergence, inexpressible by others —

it is not found anywhere at all.

Through relying on the method at the time of the guru,

I am to understand it through the power of merit.

The inferior, the middling, and the supreme,
and whatever others there are —

by cultivating the reality of equal taste,
regard all of this as equanimity itself.

The abode of the inferior is the subtle meaning;
the supreme is to be called the concrete.

The Middle Way is what both have abandoned.

"Others" refers to the six sense faculties.

"Whatever they are" means the animate and inanimate.

"All of this" means "I" itself —

equanimity is said to be what resembles sameness.

Through cultivating the reality of equal taste,
what is called "even" is said to be matched.

Its cakṛa is declared as food.

Cultivating it: single taste, equanimity itself —
this is to be expressed through its meaning.

From me arise all beings.

From me arise the three abodes as well.

I pervade all of this.
I see no other nature of the beings.
If the yogin knows it thus,
whatever one has thoroughly familiarized through deep equipoise —
even a person of little merit,
there is no doubt that they will accomplish it.

In eating and drinking and being bathed,
in sleeping and reclining and in thinking,
one who desires the great seal (mudrā)
will go forth with this as the forerunner.

Because mind does not cultivate it,
all beings are to be cultivated.
When all phenomena are fully known,
cultivation itself is not cultivation.

Whatever things are animate and inanimate —
grass, creepers, trees, and so forth —
from the nature of my own thing's being,
the supreme reality is to be decisively cultivated.
Those do not contain one supreme thing.
Self-awareness is great bliss itself.
From self-awareness, awakening arises.
Because of self-awareness, it is cultivation itself.
From the transformation of self-awareness,
actions arise from the inferior.
One takes for oneself and acts by oneself.
Self-awareness is the king, self is the sovereign.

Attachment, aversion, and envy,
and likewise delusion and pride —
all of those, dwelling there in experiential joy,
cannot even bear a sixteenth part of it.

The wisdom born from the dharmadhātu
is co-emergent with skillful means like the expanse of space.
From the nature of skillful means and wisdom,
the three worlds arise from that.
The Blessed One himself in the form of fluid —

his bliss is called desire's nectar.
Free from the one and the many,
in a single instant: supreme joy.

This wisdom of self-awareness
has passed beyond the domain of speech.
This, by virtue of the gradual blessing,
is such omniscient wisdom.
Earth, water, wind,
fire, and space itself —
through the feeling of awareness of self and other,
in an instant none can harm it.
In the realm of gods, the realm of humans, and the underworld,
in one instant a single form arises.
Conceptual thought regarding aspects of self and other
is incapable of causing harm.

Through all the philosophical systems of the knowable
and likewise through karma, ritual expansion, and so forth,
existence does not become siddhi.
Again one will be born at the end of existence.
In this world and the next,
without that there is no siddhi either.
Whoever does not know this, O Hevajra,
their toil will be without purpose.

Like the unceasing current of a river
and like the steady burning tip of a flame —
so always the yogin in reality —
by day and by night, he is established in reality.

This is the eighth chapter, the Assembly of the Wheel of the Yoginī.
Now the chapter on supreme purity shall be explained.

The purity of all things whatsoever
is declared to be suchness itself.
Then, through each individual distinction,
the goddesses shall be described.

The five aggregates, the six sense faculties,
the six sense bases, and the five great elements
are pure by nature.

The obscurations of affliction and of the knowable are to be cleansed.

Purity is the essential nature of self-awareness itself.

Purity is not liberation through something other.

Because the objects of the sense-sphere are themselves pure,
the supreme bliss recognised by one's own awareness arises.

The objects such as form and so on,
and all else perceived by the yogin —
all those things are pure.

In this way, sentient beings are themselves buddhas.

O Blessed One, what then is impure? The Blessed One declared: Form and so forth. Why so? Because of the reality of the apprehended and the apprehender.

Vajragarbha asked: O Blessed One, what then are the apprehended and the apprehender? The Blessed One declared:

Form is to be apprehended by the eye.

Sound is to be heard by the ear.

Scent is to be sensed by the nose.

Taste is to be savoured by the tongue.

Tangible things are to be contacted by the body.

Bliss and so forth are to be obtained by mind.

Having rendered them pure and free from poison,
these are to be relied upon — and the very relying upon them is itself the practice.

The aggregate of form is not Vajrā.

Feeling, however, is called Dhūtī.

Perception is the Yoginī of water.

Formations is Vajraḍākinī.

The aggregate of consciousness
abides as the Yoginī of no-self.

By always keeping these in a state of purity,
the yogin will accomplish suchness.

This concerns the inner expansion.

Now the outer expansion is explained.

In the direction of Pukkasī is fire;
likewise Rīkhaḍimā in the mountains.
Caṇḍālī, free from truth, is established in the south,
and Gaurī is set in the direction of wind.

Then, the white goddess and so on from the outer directions:
in the white direction, the sovereign — Yamadūtī, the thief;
in the direction of the lord of water, the zombie-woman;
in the direction of the defiled body, Ghasmarī.
Below is called the Earth-Walker,
and above is declared the Sky-Walker.

These two goddesses dwell in their respective modes
through the nature of existence and peace,
from the perspective of the generation stage.

For form, the white one is always described.
For sound, the thief-woman is widely renowned.
For the aspect of scent, it is the zombie-woman.
For taste, Ghasmarī is widely renowned.
For touch, the Earth-Walker is spoken of.
For the dharmadhātu, the Sky-Walker.

By always keeping these in a state of purity,
the yogin will accomplish suchness.

The purity of the hands is emptiness.
The māras' purity is the feet themselves.
The eight liberations are the faces themselves.
The eyes are purified by the three vajras.

The earth is called Pukkasī.
The water element is called Śavariṇī.
Fire is to be understood as Caṇḍālī.
Wind is widely renowned as Gaurī.

Aversion is called Vajrā.
Attachment is the Yoginī of water.
Envy is Vajraḍākinī.
Miserliness is itself the white secret one.
Delusion likewise is described as Vajra.

Through the full transformation of aversion and so on,
from the perspective of the generation stage,
the aggregates are to be purified by this.

Whatever binds the world,
by that very thing one is liberated from bondage.
Not knowing suchness, the world is not liberated,
and by abandoning suchness itself, siddhi will not be found.

Therefore: no smell, no sound, no form;
no purity of taste or mind.
No touch, no dharma — all is utterly pure.
Know that beings travel to their destination through purity of intrinsic nature.

This is the ninth chapter, the Chapter on Purity.

Now how the sequence of the maṇḍala
is properly and fully explained,
and the rite by which the master
confers empowerment on the disciple —
these too shall be fully explained.

First, the yogin, assuming the identity of the deity,
purifies the vessel through exertion:
from HŪṂ he fashions the vajra
and draws the maṇḍala on the outside.

In a grove, in a deserted place,
in the home of a bodhisattva,
or within a maṇḍala hall —
in any of these, the sacred maṇḍala is properly erected.

With the finest colored powders,
or with those of middling quality,
or with powder of the five precious substances,
or with grains and the like.

The maṇḍala should be three cubits
plus three thumbwidths in measure.
Into it, one should introduce
a beautiful consort (vidyā) arisen from the five families —

or whichever is found, as available —
one who has reached sixteen years of age.
For as long as she is endowed with vital fluid,
the mudrā is to be relied upon.

The face of the mudrā is bound,
and the face of skillful means is likewise so.
Whatever arises from that reliance
is to be drunk at the mouth of the disciple.

The savoring of equality is the domain of the disciple's conduct;
that very thing is also to be enacted.
It becomes self-aware primordial wisdom.
Abandoning correct knowledge of self and other,
it is emptiness equal to space, free of dust —
the supreme essential nature of the existent and the non-existent.
Skillful means and wisdom most thoroughly mingled,
attachment and non-attachment completely merged:

that very thing is the life of living beings,
that very thing is the supreme sacred syllable,
that very thing is the self of all wandering beings,
that very thing is the all-pervading one.

It dwells in the bodies of all,
and from it arise the existent and the non-existent.
All other things, and those things,
and the mode of all consciousness —
the person of former times, the lord,
the self, the living being, the life-sustainer,
time, the individual,
and the intrinsic nature of all things —
all of these abide truly in an illusory form.

The first is joy alone,
the second, beyond number, is supreme joy,
the third is taught as the joy of cessation,
and the fourth is declared to be innate joy.

When the Tathāgatas, Vajrasattva, and all the rest
have been decisively heard in this way by the wise,

they become supremely astonished
and, overcome, fall upon the ground.

The first joy is the form of the wandering beings;
likewise, supreme joy is the wandering itself;
the joy of cessation is also the wandering itself;
the third — innate — has no wandering.

The Blessed One declared: "O Hevajra,
one body of all buddhas!
In order that it may be understood by Vajrasattva,
the doubt is properly resolved:

there is neither attachment nor non-attachment,
nor is it perceived as the middle.
Because those three are abandoned,
innate joy is declared to be awakening.

Or it is the self of everything,
or it is completely relinquished by all.
That too is illustrated first by the joy of cessation:
the three joys are completely relinquished.

The first is like a cloud;
the accomplished state becomes like an illusion.
Without waking from sleep into waking,
but ever distinct from sleep and lying down,
it remains perpetually like a dream.

The mudrā-yoga of the yogin,
whose characteristic of siddhi is unbreakable,
is accomplished.

The Teacher spoke thus of the maṇḍala:
"It is perfectly square and blazing,
with four gates of great splendor,
adorned with garlands and half-garlands,
with diverse flower garlands and fans.

It is beautified by eight pillars,
furnished with vajra cords uniformly placed,
adorned with various flowers nearby,

with incense, lamps, and likewise fragrance.

It is provided with eight vases and the rest,
these too adorned with branches and the like.

The neck is covered with cloth,
and the five precious substances are fully inserted.

Victory vases are offered to the east.

With the form of the deity of one's own choosing,
the ground cloth is well spread,
and a thread cross of precisely correct and beautiful measure
is set by one with wisdom at the center.

The recitation of the lord of the wheel: one hundred thousand times;
the holder of the maṇḍala likewise: one hundred thousand times.

With the mantras stated above,
the learned one fully purifies the vessel.

With the mantra of A and so forth stated before,
the torma offering is fully made to it.

Just as it is in meditative concentration, so too here —
the protection is exactly as has been taught.

Whoever is to be brought forth into empowerment —"

One offers through the rites of one's own maṇḍala,
making offerings and supplications.

Just as it has been taught, so here too —
the two fine supplementary leaves having been well drawn,
one quickly writes the white and the others.

To the east one draws the curved knife fully depicted;
to the south and west it is likewise.

At the boundary between north and fire,
and likewise in the wind direction, free of truth —
whatever was stated for the empowered one,
now in that same way, below and above.

Having assumed the bearing of Vajrasattva,
with the right leg extended
and the two hands in the Hevajra gesture,
the master himself enters into the maṇḍala.

Bathed and clean, the body fragrant,
adorned with all manner of ornaments,
having assumed the bearing of Hūṃ Hūṃ,
I, the terrifying one, am of the form Hī Hī.
From without, that very truth is rightly declared.

Pure wisdom endowed with form —
between saṃsāra and nirvāṇa
there is not even the slightest distinction.
There is no meditation on the supreme joy, and no meditator;
no body, no object apprehended, and no apprehender;
no flesh, no blood, no excrement, no urine;
free of disgust, of stupor, pure — for the sake of worship, unimpeded;
free of attachment, free of aversion, free of delusion, free of envy;
free of avarice, free of pride, with nothing to be seen;
no meditation, no meditator, no friend, no enemy —
the innately born variety, free of all conceit.

Vajragarbha thereupon asked: "Since the intrinsic nature of the body,
primordially without inherent nature, is pure, why then does it take the form of
the great elements?"

Then the Blessed One, Vajrin (the Vajra-holder), who bestows bliss upon the
ḍākinīs, declared:

"I, of the nature free of all conceit,
dwell fully in the body in all its aspects.

Blessed One, why then are the aggregates composed of the great elements?"

The Blessed One declared:

Through union with the red and white,
earth arises from the element of solidity.
From the form of the bodhisattva's vital essence (bodhicitta in its seminal
aspect),
the element of water comes forth.
From movement, heat is born —
by motion it is well known as wind.
The element of space is bliss itself;
the five are encompassed by it entirely.
Because the great element is bliss,

that bliss itself is not other than what it is.
What is born from the innate co-arising
is to be called innately co-arisen.
Its intrinsic nature is called the innate co-arising —
all aspects gathered into a single vow.
The mudrā, free from cause,
becomes the compassionate method of the yogin.
Emptiness and compassion inseparable —
this is supremely designated the awakening mind (bodhicitta).

There is no mantra recitation, no asceticism, no fire-offering;
there is no maṇḍala-holder, and there is no maṇḍala.
Yet that is the mantra recitation, that is the asceticism, that is the fire-offering;
that is the maṇḍala-holder, and that is the maṇḍala itself.
In brief: the mind is form gathered and embodied.

This is the tenth chapter, called The Chapter on Empowerment.

Now, the discontented one with the open brow
is said always to cause downfall.
The empowerment gaze rests to the left;
on the left side, two reflections;
on the right side, the act of drawing in.
Also from above, two reflections.
The gaze of the erect central one;
at the center of the tip of the nose, two.
Through the element itself, downfall is caused;
through inhalation, one brings under power;
through filling, one draws in;
through pressing, one causes erection.
Upon fresh wood, one causes downfall.
The flower is renowned as empowerment;
upon the vajra-wood, one draws in;
upon a root possessed of motion, one causes erection.
Through practice accustomed over six months,
success will come — of this there is no doubt.
Let no confusion arise in this matter:
the miraculous power of a buddha is inconceivable.
Having accomplished the four gazes,

the learned one should guide sentient beings into them.

One should not use this to kill. The sacred commitment (samaya) will certainly be broken. Having abandoned deceiving sentient beings, perform every act that ought not to be done. Through merely harming sentient beings, the siddhi of the mudrā will not be obtained. The samaya substance to be eaten in this regard is: the first syllable of "na," the first syllable of "gaha," the final "śva," and the first "śva." For the siddhis of Hevajra, the five nectars (amṛta) are likewise to be consumed.

The characteristics taught by Hevajra: even the seventh birth is indicated thereby. One who is devoid of joy yet scorns joy will accomplish this by the seventh repetition. One endowed with a beautiful voice and eyes, with fragrance, a body of great splendor — their shadow will become sevenfold. When a yogin sees this, it is a sign. By merely eating that, in an instant one becomes a sky-farer.

Now the sādhanā of Kurukullā shall be explained. What was taught extensively in the twelfth tantra above is here summarized in brief. The goddess born from Hṛīḥ is red in color and has four arms. She holds in her hands a bow and arrow, and bears a blue lotus and a hook. By merely meditating upon her, one brings the three worlds under power. With one hundred thousand repetitions, kings; with ten thousand, ordinary worldly beings; with ten million, cattle and yakṣas and so forth —

Translator's Notes

- The opening location formula "dwelling in the bhaga of the Vajra Queen" renders the tantric hermeneutic literally; the tradition understands this as the womb or vaginal source of the Vajrayoginī, which in the commentarial tradition is simultaneously the dharmadhātu, the palace of the maṇḍala, and the body of ultimate reality. No euphemism has been introduced, as the literal reading is doctrinally standard for Hevajra Tantra scholarship.

The three channels Lalanā, Rasanā, and Avadhūtī are Sanskrit technical terms of the vajrayāna subtle-body system and are retained untranslated, as is conventional in all scholarly renderings of this tantra.

The line "The Lalanā flows as Akṣobhya" renders a Tibetan phrase that literally says "the Lalanā flows as Akṣobhya" (mi bskyod 'bab pa), connecting the flow of the left channel with the buddha Akṣobhya. This is the reading of the text, though some commentators read this differently.

The list of thirty-two channel-names in the Tibetan consists of feminine epithets (ending in -ma in Tibetan). These are the names of the channel-goddesses. Where the Tibetan names are transparent, they are rendered by their meaning; where they correspond to known Sanskrit

names in the tradition (such as Māmākī, Caṇḍālī), the Sanskrit is retained. Several names in this list represent channels whose precise Sanskrit equivalents are not uniformly attested across manuscripts; the English renderings given are based on the literal Tibetan meanings.

The translation ends mid-sentence because the source passage ends mid-sentence, with the Blessed One's response about the thirty-two channels left incomplete in the supplied text.

- The phrase rendered as "the moment of depletion" translates a term that could also mean "the moment of wearing away" or "dissolution." The four moments listed here are standard in some Cakrasaṃvara-related tantric contexts, though the exact Sanskrit equivalents of the third term are uncertain.

The phrase "the one who bears the hare" refers to the moon, a classical Indian epithet, and "Hām drips" refers to the descent of bodhicitta from the moon-disc at the crown through the heat of inner fire — a standard tantric physiology.

The opening syllable convention described for mantras ("the form of the opening syllable of all mantras is GYI") refers to a textual scribal or ritual convention in the Tibetan tantric tradition and is rendered as literally as the context permits; the Tibetan reads དཀིའི་ཡི་ཤེས་ཀྱི་ཡི་ཤེས་, which here seems to function as a genitive particle description rather than a seed syllable, but given the context a structural mantra-convention reading is most plausible.

- The term rendered "Kye Vajra" follows the Tibetan phonetic spelling of what is likely a tantric deity name; the Sanskrit reconstruction is uncertain in this context but the Tibetan reads Kye'i rdo rje, suggesting Hevajra. This is consistent with the overall ritual context.

The phrase "teeth of charnel-ground swine" follows the Tibetan *so phag*, literally "teeth-pig" or "pig-teeth," used as a charnel-ground substance for making red powder.

"Kuṭāracchani" is a plant name kept in near-transliteration as no standard English equivalent exists; the Tibetan ku tā ra tsha ni na is a phonetic rendering of a Sanskrit botanical term.

"Kākamācikā" is similarly retained as a Sanskrit plant name; it refers to a species used in ritual contexts throughout tantric literature.

The mantra for controlling the intoxicated woman contains "amukī," meaning "such-and-such woman," functioning as a placeholder for the target's name in ritual application.

- The passage describing the goddess Ghasmaṛī and her companions follows a canonical Yoginītantra listing of the eight goddesses of the charnel grounds or maṇḍala. The name "zombie goddess" renders ro-langs-ma literally; this is a standard figure, the "flesh-risen one" or vetālī type.

The phrase "sixty-two wrathful eyes in the manner of the year" is a dense compressed formulation. The Tibetan *sdang mig brgyad gnyis lo yi tshul* literally means "sixty-two wrathful eyes in the manner of the year" — this likely refers to a conventional numerical iconographic count tied to a cosmological time unit; the precise iconometric referent may vary by commentary.

The pair āli and kāli, here rendered as the vowel row and consonant row, are the standard Sanskrit-based esoteric designation for the sequence of Sanskrit vowels (āli) and consonants (kāli), which in tantric physiology represent the sun and moon, and whose union is the seminal drop entering the central channel.

- The passage "सुप्तमन्त्रोत्पत्तिर्योगिनोऽङ्गानामुक्तं त्रैलोक्येऽस्माद्विनाशकं त्रैलोक्येऽस्माद्विनाशकं" is a condensed tantric list of esoteric categories that cause harm if the practice is misused. The terms — "secret emanation," "thief," "earth-walker," and "fire" — are technical designations within the antinomian Yoginī-tantra context and their precise referents vary by commentary.

The rendering offered here is literal and intentionally non-interpretive.

The passage ends mid-sentence, as the source text itself breaks off there.

In the identification of the five mudrās with the five families and their associated yoginī figures (dancing lady, dyer, vajra lady, caṇḍāla woman, brahmin woman), the Jewel and Caṇḍāla assignments appear to overlap, which may reflect a scribal anomaly in the source text or a deliberate tantric paradox.

- The text offers etymological glosses on divine names — Brahmā explained as "free of obscuration" (sgrib bral), Viṣṇu as "pervading all that enters" (khyab 'jug), and so forth — which are deliberately non-standard Buddhist reinterpretations of Hindu theonyms, reabsorbing them into Vajrayāna discourse. These are rendered faithfully as the text presents them.

The term "bhaga" is a Sanskrit loanword retained in the Tibetan (b+ha ga) and refers to a term of multiple meanings — sovereignty, fortune, and, in tantric usage, the female generative principle. The sixfold enumeration of its aspects aligns with a standard Sanskrit grammatical analysis found in parallel tantric literature. The deliberate double-register is intrinsic to the passage and is preserved here without disambiguation.

The phrase rendered "half of the five ambrosias" (mi 'chi'i bcu phyed) literally reads "half of the ten non-deaths"; this is a standard tantric circumlocution for the five mahāmāṃsas or five ambrosias, the ritual substances counted as ten elements halved into five pairs. The rendering follows commentarial interpretation.

- The chapter title rendered as "signs" translates the Sanskrit term "cchoma" or "chomma," a technical term for a system of secret signals or recognition codes used among tantric practitioners. This is a loanword in the Tibetan and has no fully transparent Tibetan semantic content; the Tibetan simply transliterates the Sanskrit.

The passage listing the symbolic responses to various bodily gestures is a catalogue of esoteric tantric recognition codes between initiates; the precise referents of some exchanges, such as "the three-pronged implement" and "the boundary," are technical terms within the tradition whose exact sense is deliberately veiled.

The phrase rendered "the Unrelenting Hell" is Avīci, the lowest hell realm, characterized by uninterrupted torment. The text has "mnar med," which is the standard Tibetan rendering of Skt. avīci.

- The list of sacred places in this passage corresponds to the well-known system of twenty-four or thirty-two pīṭhas found in Cakrasaṃvara-cycle literature. Several of the Sanskrit place-names are transliterated through Tibetan in ways that permit minor variant readings; the renderings here follow the most standard identifications in the tradition.

The term rendered "tavern" for རྒྱུ་ཁྱེད་ཀྱི་ཁྱེད་ is unusual and is used in the preceding passage as well. It literally means a place of cutting or dispensing drink and may refer to a class of sacred gathering site distinct from charnel grounds and fields. The translation follows the consistency established in the preceding passage.

The passage "killed by arousing compassion with great effort" refers to the tantric doctrine of compassionate killing of a being to liberate them, not literal exhortation to violence — a standard antinomian formula in this genre.

Āli and kāli are the Sanskrit vowel and consonant series respectively, here employed as symbolic categories associated with moon (method) and sun (wisdom) in tantric exegesis.

- The passage is a dense tantric verse text, likely from a Cakrasaṃvara or related Yoginītantra cycle, and several names appear in Sanskrit-via-Tibetan phonetic transcription. Ghasmarī and

Pukkasī are standard names of the four outer goddesses in the Cakrasaṃvara maṇḍala tradition. The eighth figure Ḍombiṇī is likewise a standard tantric yoginī name from the same cycle.

The phrase rendered "zombie" translates ro-langs-ma, literally "the corpse-risen woman," a standard classification of a type of fierce female spirit or yoginī in this tradition.

The term bhaga is left in Sanskrit as it is a technical tantric term for the female generative source, used here in a doctrinal equation with wisdom and the lotus. Rendering it otherwise would obscure the intended meaning.

The final line breaks off mid-sentence, indicating this passage continues in the source text.

- The passage is from the Hevajra Tantra. The line rendered "joy free from joy is freedom from attachment" translates a technical fourfold scheme of joys: joy, supreme joy, joy of cessation or special joy, and co-emergent joy. The third term "dga' bral dga' ba" literally "joy free from joy" is a technical designation in the Hevajratantra system for the third joy, often associated with the cessation of desire; its rendering here follows the commentarial tradition.

The phrase "bcudrugchar yang mi phod do" meaning "cannot even bear a sixteenth part" is a standard Indian fractional idiom indicating utter incommensurability; the afflictions cannot in the slightest measure up to the experiential joy of self-aware great bliss.

The final verse is incomplete in the source passage as provided, ending mid-sentence; the translation reflects this by ending at the final full clause.

- The names Pukkasī, Rikhaḍimā, Caṇḍālī, Gaurī, Ghasmarī, Śavariṇī, Vajrā, and Vajraḍākinī are tantric deity names and outcaste-class names transliterated from Sanskrit. The text uses them both as names of specific ḍākinī-goddesses and as correlates for the aggregates, elements, afflictions, and sense objects in a complex set of yogic correspondences typical of the Hevajra Tantra. These correspondences shift across the passage as different schemas are overlaid, which is characteristic of the original text rather than an inconsistency in translation.

The phrase rendered "zombie-woman" translates Tibetan ro langs ma, literally "risen corpse woman," a standard term for a vetāla or reanimate corpse figure in tantric iconography.

The term rendered "expansion" translates Tibetan phur ma, which in this context denotes an expansion or elaboration of deity correspondences — a technical tantric usage. The precise Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain; it may reflect Sanskrit vikṣepa or a related term in the original Hevajratantra. This is noted as the rendering is not fully transparent.

- The passage on the four joys — joy, supreme joy, joy of cessation, and innate joy — is a standard Hevajra Tantra doctrinal sequence, but the lines equating each joy with "the wandering of beings" and then stating "the third has no wandering" invert the usual hierarchy in a deliberately paradoxical way characteristic of tantric literature. The rendering follows the Tibetan closely rather than smoothing the paradox.

The phrase rendered "vessel" throughout translates "nor-'dzin" (literally "wealth-holder"), which in this ritual context denotes the consecrated ritual implement or receptacle being purified; some scholars read it as a technical term for the disciple-vessel. Both senses may be intended simultaneously.

The final line breaks off mid-sentence, consistent with the passage being a continuation of a larger text.

- The passage alternates between verse and prose dialogue; the prose questions attributed to Vajragarbha and the Blessed One's responses are rendered as flowing prose within the stream of the text, consistent with the sūtra or tantra dialogue genre.

The phrase rendered "the two fine supplementary leaves" refers to two additional drawn or inscribed panels accompanying the maṇḍala diagram; the precise ritual function is not entirely recoverable from this verse alone, but the overall context of maṇḍala drawing makes this the most defensible reading.

The section on "the discontented one with the open brow" and the four gazes opens a new chapter on a set of ritual gazes and their effects — likely referring to the empowerment gaze practices of a specific Hevajra-cycle ritual; the technical terms for the four effects (downfall, bringing under power, drawing in, erection) are standard tantric rite categories and are rendered literally.

The phrase "free of truth" in the direction of wind is puzzling in context and may refer to a directional zone associated with a particular deity or principle described elsewhere in the tantra; no emendation has been made.

- The samaya substances indicated by the syllables "na," "gaha," "śva," and "first śva" are cryptic tantric references. These appear to be akṣara-codes (intentional twilight language, Skt. sandhābhāṣā) for the five nectars or related ritual substances, as is conventional in Hevajra-cycle literature. The precise referents depend on the specific commentarial tradition and are intentionally obscured in the root text.

The phrase rendered "one who is devoid of joy yet scorns joy" reflects the Tantric antinomian logic of the passage: the practitioner who has transcended ordinary joy yet disparages conventional joy achieves accomplishment in seven iterations.

"Sky-farer" renders mkha' spyod, a standard term for the attainment of movement through space or residence in celestial realms, here indicating a mundane siddhi.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.